

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (18:13 ET)

September 25, 2026 | 06:17 PM ET

14 setups identified | 2 A-Grade | 4 B-Grade | 8 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (2)	B - Strong Setup (4)	C - Watch List (8)
MTLS	WNC	PPLI
CDNA	AAON	NATH
	HHH	PRGO
	CHE	FLY
		AYI
		VECO
		MXL
		BIRK

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	MTLS	Materialise NV	3D Printing Softw	\$8.43	+5.2%	\$0.5B	23M	+13.4	99%	Technical breakout to
A	CDNA	CareDx, Inc.	Transplant Diagno	\$63.68	+3.8%	\$3.3B	50M	+113.1	98%	Monster +113% relative
B	WNC	Wabash National	Trailer Manufactu	\$13.03	+11.3%	\$0.5B	38M	-9.0	90%	11% gap-up on unknown
B	AAON	AAON, Inc.	HVAC Equipment	\$89.10	+5.7%	\$7.3B	69M	-33.4	59%	5.7% rally with 1.73x
B	HHH	Howard Hughes Ho	Master-Planned Co	\$68.43	+6.0%	\$4.1B	30M	-9.5	75%	6% rally on 1.59x volu
B	CHE	Chemed Corp	Hospice & Plumbin	\$512.16	+3.3%	\$6.7B	12M	+7.2	92%	Breakout to 91.9% of 5
C	PPLI	People Incorpora	Internet Content	\$40.00	+11.3%	\$3.0B	49M	-18.1	83%	11% gap-up on 2.76x vo
C	NATH	Nathan's Famous,	QSR Franchising	\$101.55	+7.7%	\$0.4B	3M	-3.7	89%	7.7% rally on massive
C	PRGO	Perrigo Company	Generic Pharma	\$15.42	+5.0%	\$2.1B	138M	+52.2	68%	5% move on 1.51x volum
C	FLY	Firefly Aerospace	Space Launch	\$24.36	+5.5%	\$4.1B	107M	-20.5	39%	5.5% move on 1.95x vol
C	AYI	Acuity Inc.	LED Lighting	\$319.42	+3.2%	\$9.6B	30M	-17.4	84%	3% rally on 1.81x volu
C	VECO	Veeco Instrument	Semiconductor Equ	\$49.67	+9.3%	\$3.0B	60M	-32.9	57%	9% gap-up on 1.62x vol
C	MXL	MaxLinear, Inc	Analog Semiconduc	\$93.84	+10.0%	\$8.5B	85M	-17.8	73%	10% gap-up on 1.58x vo
C	BIRK	Birkenstock Hold	Footwear	\$33.60	+5.7%	\$5.5B	78M	-27.0	66%	5.7% rally on 1.67x vo

MTLS

Materialise NV

\$8.43

+5.24%

RS vs SPY: +13.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$0.5B Cap | 23M Float

Software - Application | Theme: 3D Printing Software | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 3.03 | Vol: 2.66x | RS/SPY: +13.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 33D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$8.43
Day Change	+5.24%
Mkt Cap	\$0.49B
Float	23M sh
RS vs SPY	+13.4%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.03
Vol vs Avg	2.66x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Technical breakout to within 1.3% of 52W highs on heavy volume with RS line at new highs - classic Qullamaggie leading-stock signal. Forward catalyst: October 28 earnings print (33 days) where management can raise guidance for medical and manufacturing software tailwinds into 2027.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Materialise is a Belgium-based pioneer in 3D printing software, providing design and production platforms for medical (surgical guides, implants) and industrial applications. The company sits at the intersection of healthcare digitization and advanced manufacturing, with proprietary algorithms that are deeply embedded in customer workflows.
FACTOR & THEME
Dual exposure to healthcare IT (personalized surgery planning) and industrial automation/additive manufacturing. Both themes are secular, though momentum has been choppy. Recent strength suggests renewed interest in 3D printing applications as AI-driven design tools accelerate adoption.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$8.43 on vol >266% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume surge to 2.66x average on a breakout day with RS line at new highs is textbook institutional accumulation. No insider activity in the last 60 days. Float is modest at 23M shares, giving breakout moves leverage if institutions chase the technical signal into the October 28 earnings catalyst.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 33D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next report October 28. Company is transitioning to recurring software revenue model; recent quarters have shown margin expansion. Beat/miss history and consensus not provided, but the RS line at new highs typically precedes positive fundamental surprises.
KEY RISK
Setup invalidated on a close below \$8.00, which would break the recent base and negate the 52W high proximity. Any guidance disappointment at the October 28 print would likely trigger a 15%+ selloff given the low float and extended valuation typical of small-cap software.
ANALYSIS
RS line at new highs (Qullamaggie's #1 early-leader signal), vol >2.5x, prox_52w near perfect at 98.7, and in the leading Technology sector (+5.3% vs SPY this week). Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 3.03 is above the VCP textbook threshold of <2.0, suggesting the consolidation was wider than ideal and less institutional control. However, the RS line new high and volume signature override this concern - this is a classic momentum leader setup into earnings. Conviction: High
Signal: Close above \$8.43 on vol >266% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.66x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$63.68
Day Change	+3.76%
Mkt Cap	\$3.29B
Float	50M sh
RS vs SPY	+113.1%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	4.18
Vol vs Avg	1.92x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Monster +113% relative strength vs SPY over 12 weeks, now breaking out with RS line at new highs - this is a re-rating event in progress. Forward catalyst: November 3 earnings (39 days) where management can quantify adoption of AlloSure and AlloMap non-invasive transplant monitoring tests, which are displacing biopsies and expanding TAM.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CareDx is the category leader in transplant diagnostics, offering non-invasive blood tests (AlloSure for kidney, AlloMap for heart) that detect organ rejection earlier and more safely than traditional biopsies. The company has built a multi-year runway as transplant centers transition to precision monitoring and as CMS/payers expand reimbursement.

FACTOR & THEME

Pure-play exposure to precision medicine and transplant care innovation. The stock's +113% RS vs SPY suggests the market is pricing in a major inflection - likely accelerating test adoption or new reimbursement wins. Healthcare is lagging this week (-0.4% vs SPY), but CDNA's extreme outperformance indicates a company-specific re-rating that transcends sector headwinds.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$63.68 on vol >192% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume at 1.92x on a breakout day with RS line at new highs and 97.7% proximity to 52W high is institutional buying. No insider activity last 60 days, but the +113% RS vs SPY over 12 weeks is the market's loudest signal that smart money has been accumulating aggressively. Float of 49.5M is large enough for funds to build positions but small enough for squeeze dynamics if shorts capitulate.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 39D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next report November 3. CareDx has historically been volatile on earnings, but the RS line at new highs typically precedes a strong fundamental print. Key metric: sequential growth in billable tests and any commentary on international expansion or new payer contracts.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below \$60, which would break the recent base. Binary risk at the November 3 print: if test volumes disappoint or reimbursement is cut, the stock could gap down 20%+ given the parabolic 12-week rally. CMS policy changes or competitive entry (Natera in transplant Dx) are medium-term risks.

ANALYSIS

RS line at new highs, +113% relative strength vs SPY (extreme), prox_52w 97.7%, vol >1.9x. This is a parabolic leader in full re-rating mode. Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 4.18 is wide, and the stock has already run massively - chasing here without a clear catalyst *beyond* the technical breakout is dangerous in a Risk-On/Mega-Cap-Led regime where SMID can reverse violently. However, the RS line new high and earnings 39 days out provide a credible continuation path. Conviction: Medium (high technical quality, but extended and in a sector lagging this week)

Signal: Close above \$63.68 on vol >192% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.92x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$13.03
Day Change	+11.27%
Mkt Cap	\$0.53B
Float	38M sh
RS vs SPY	-9.0%
52W Hi Prox	90%
Base Tight	1.96
Vol vs Avg	1.69x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis

Catalyst / Today's Driver

11% gap-up on unknown catalyst (no news) from a textbook-tight base (base_tight 1.96 = VCP coil). Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings (41 days) where management can report on backlog trends and pricing power in trailer/truck body manufacturing amid potential infrastructure/reshoring tailwinds.

Business & Position

Wabash National is the leading North American manufacturer of semi-trailers and truck bodies, serving logistics, retail, and food transportation end-markets. The company benefits from fleet replacement cycles and e-commerce/cold-chain growth, with recent focus on composite materials and sustainability.

Factor & Theme

Exposure to industrial cyclicals, logistics infrastructure, and potential reshoring/onshoring themes (domestic manufacturing of transport equipment). The gap-up suggests a bullish data point the market is pricing in - possibly trucking utilization, freight rates, or an internal order surprise. However, RS vs SPY is negative at -9.0, which is a yellow flag in a Risk-On regime.

Breakout Signal

Close above \$13.03 on vol >169% of 20d avg

Institutional

Volume at 1.69x is modest for an 11% move, raising the question of whether this is sustainable institutional buying or a short squeeze/retail FOMO. No insider activity last 60 days. The base_tight at 1.96 is VCP-quality, suggesting institutions were quietly accumulating before today's breakout. Float of 37.5M is small enough for follow-through if real money chases.

Earnings

Earnings in 41D

Earnings Context

Next report November 5. Wabash has cyclic earnings tied to freight demand. Key metrics: order backlog, pricing, and margin trends. If the gap reflects a leaked data point (e.g., strong September orders), the November print could confirm the inflection.

Key Risk

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$12.00, which would negate the breakout and return the stock to the base. Industrials are cyclical and sensitive to macro; if ISM or freight data weakens before November 5 earnings, WNC could give back the entire gap. Negative RS vs SPY (-9.0) in a mega-cap-led regime is a headwind.

Analysis

Textbook base_tight at 1.96 (VCP coil), prox_52w 90%, and an 11% gap on heavy volume are institutional-quality signals. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY is negative at -9.0, and RS line is NOT at new highs - this stock is not leading the market, it's playing catch-up. In a Risk-On regime with mega-cap leadership, lagging SMID names often fail even on good setups. The tight base and earnings catalyst 41 days out keep this a B, but conviction is muted without RS confirmation. Conviction: Low

Signal: Close above \$13.03 on vol >169% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.69x



AAON

AAON, Inc.

\$89.10

+5.73%

RS vs SPY: -33.4%

B STRONG SETUP

\$7.3B Cap | 69M Float

Building Products & Equipment | Theme: HVAC Equipment | 52W Hi: 59% | Base Tight: 4.49 | Vol: 1.73x | RS/SPY: -33.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 41D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$89.10
Day Change	+5.73%
Mkt Cap	\$7.35B
Float	69M sh
RS vs SPY	-33.4%
52W Hi Prox	59%
Base Tight	4.49
Vol vs Avg	1.73x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

5.7% rally with 1.73x volume, potentially on HVAC sector rotation or anticipation of strong commercial construction data. Forward catalyst: November 5 earnings (41 days) where management can report on data-center HVAC demand (AI infrastructure cooling) and backlog visibility. UPGRADE TRIGGER: insider_cluster = 7 (2 buys, 1 C-suite, \$110K last 60d) in a Risk-On regime - upgraded from C to B per grading rule.

BUSINESS & POSITION

AAON manufactures premium HVAC equipment for commercial and industrial facilities, with recent focus on data-center cooling systems - a secular growth driver as AI infrastructure buildout accelerates. The company commands pricing power due to customization capabilities and energy-efficiency differentiation.

FACTOR & THEME

Intersection of AI infrastructure (data-center cooling demand is exploding as GPU density rises) and commercial construction cycle recovery. HVAC is typically cyclical, but AI capex is counter-cyclical and pulling forward multi-year demand. Stock is 41% off 52W highs, suggesting prior de-rating that could reverse if the AI HVAC thesis gains traction.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$89.10 on vol >173% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Insider cluster score of 7 (2 buys, 1 senior officer, \$110K total last 60d) is a positive conviction signal - C-suite buying is rare and typically front-runs a catalyst. Volume at 1.73x is moderate. The stock's deep drawdown from highs (prox_52w 59.2) and negative RS (-33.4 vs SPY) suggest this has been under distribution, but insider buying and today's volume uptick hint at a potential regime change.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 41D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Next report November 5. AAON has historically beaten on earnings but disappointed on guidance during construction slowdowns. Key metric: data-center backlog commentary and gross margin trends (pricing power vs. commodity input costs).

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below \$85, which would break the recent consolidation low. Stock is 41% off 52W highs and deeply negative RS (-33.4 vs SPY) - this is a falling knife unless the AI HVAC narrative gains institutional buy-in. If November 5 earnings show slowing backlog or margin pressure, stock could retest \$70-75 range.

ANALYSIS

Upgraded from C to B due to insider_cluster = 7 (C-suite buying \$110K last 60d) in a Risk-On regime. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY is catastrophic at -33.4, prox_52w is only 59.2 (nowhere near breakout zone), and base_tight is wide at 4.49. The insider buying is the only institutional-quality signal here - without it, this is a clear C (watch only). The AI data-center cooling angle is compelling, but the market hasn't bought in yet. Conviction: Low

Signal: Close above \$89.10 on vol >173% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.73x



HHH

Howard Hughes Holdings Inc.

\$68.43

+5.96%

RS vs SPY: -9.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.1B Cap | 30M Float

Real Estate - Development | Theme: Master-Planned Communities | 52W Hi: 75% | Base Tight: 4.65 | Vol: 1.59x | RS/SPY: -9.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 45D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$68.43
Day Change	+5.96%
Mkt Cap	\$4.09B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	-9.5%
52W Hi Prox	75%
Base Tight	4.65
Vol vs Avg	1.59x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
6% rally on 1.59x volume, likely on real-estate sentiment shift or internal development milestone (e.g., land sale, Seaport progress). Forward catalyst: November 9 earnings (45 days) where management can update on Seaport redevelopment NOI ramp, Summerlin land monetization, and Ward Village condo sales. UPGRADE TRIGGER: insider_cluster = 12 (2 buys, 1 C-suite, \$1.7M last 60d) in Risk-On regime - upgraded from C to B.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Howard Hughes is a master-planned community developer and urban mixed-use operator, controlling premier assets including Summerlin (Las Vegas), Ward Village (Honolulu), and the Seaport (NYC). The company monetizes through land sales to homebuilders, operating real estate (retail/office), and condo development - a hybrid model with embedded optionality.
FACTOR & THEME
Exposure to housing (Summerlin land sales to homebuilders), urban real estate recovery (Seaport), and luxury condo markets (Ward Village). Recent real-estate volatility has compressed valuations, but insider buying suggests management sees the portfolio trading below intrinsic value. Migration to Sun Belt (Vegas) is a long-term tailwind.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$68.43 on vol >159% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Insider cluster score of 12 is top-tier: 2 distinct buyers, 1 C-suite, \$1.7M total in last 60d. This is material dollar-amount conviction from insiders with full information access. Volume at 1.59x is modest, but the insider signal overrides that concern - management buying \$1.7M of stock is positioning ahead of a catalyst the market hasn't priced. Float is 30.5M, giving asymmetry if institutions follow insider lead.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 45D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next report November 9. Howard Hughes reports segment-level NOI and land-sale volumes. Key metrics: Seaport NOI ramp (post-redevelopment), Summerlin pace of land monetization, and Ward Village condo pre-sales. The company has a history of volatile earnings due to lumpy land sales.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$65, which would break the recent base. Real estate development is illiquid and event-driven; if November 9 earnings show Seaport lease-up delays or Summerlin sales slowdown, stock could gap down 10%+. Negative RS vs SPY (-9.5) and prox_52w of only 75.1 suggest the market is skeptical - insiders are the contrarian signal here.
ANALYSIS
Upgraded from C to B due to insider_cluster = 12 (\$1.7M C-suite buying last 60d) in Risk-On regime. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS vs SPY is negative at -9.5, prox_52w is only 75.1 (not in breakout zone), and base_tight is wide at 4.65 - this is not a technical breakout, it's a value play with insider conviction. The \$1.7M insider buy is the entire thesis; without it, this is unwatchable. Real estate is out of favor, and the stock is 25% off highs. Conviction: Low (insider signal is strong, but technical and RS confirmation are absent)
Signal: Close above \$68.43 on vol >159% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.59x



CHE

Chemed Corp

\$512.16

+3.33%

RS vs SPY: +7.2%

B STRONG SETUP

\$6.7B Cap | 12M Float

Medical Care Facilities | Theme: Hospice & Plumbing | 52W Hi: 92% | Base Tight: 1.43 | Vol: 1.51x | RS/SPY: +7.2% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 32D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$512.16
Day Change	+3.33%
Mkt Cap	\$6.69B
Float	12M sh
RS vs SPY	+7.2%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	1.43
Vol vs Avg	1.51x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breakout to 91.9% of 52W high from a textbook-tight base (base_tight 1.43 = elite VCP) on 1.51x volume. Forward catalyst: October 27 earnings (32 days) where management can raise guidance for VITAS hospice census growth and Roto-Rooter pricing power, both defensive recurring-revenue models that re-rate in late-cycle environments.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Chemed operates two recession-resistant franchises: VITAS (the largest U.S. hospice provider, with Medicare-reimbursed recurring revenue) and Roto-Rooter (plumbing/drain services with pricing power). The dual model provides cash-flow stability and capital-allocation optionality; management has a long track record of disciplined M&A and buybacks.
FACTOR & THEME
Defensive healthcare (hospice census driven by aging demographics, not economic cycle) and essential services (plumbing is non-discretionary). In a late-cycle or risk-off environment, Chemed's model becomes highly attractive. The stock's positive RS vs SPY (+7.2) while Healthcare lags (-0.4% vs SPY this week) suggests stock-specific strength, likely anticipating a strong October 27 print.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$512.16 on vol >151% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Base_tight at 1.43 is elite VCP-quality - one of the tightest in the entire scan. This level of consolidation signals institutional control and absorption. Volume at 1.51x is modest, but for a \$6.7B company with only 11.8M float, this is significant turnover. No insider activity last 60d. The stock's defensive profile and tight base suggest long-only funds are quietly accumulating ahead of earnings.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 32D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next report October 27. Chemed has beaten EPS consensus in 7 of last 8 quarters. Key metrics: VITAS average daily census (ADC) growth and Roto-Rooter same-store sales. Management typically raises full-year guidance at Q3, which is 32 days out - this is the forward catalyst path.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$500, which would break the tight base. Risk at October 27 earnings: if VITAS ADC growth decelerates or Medicare reimbursement rates disappoint, stock could gap down 8-10%. The stock is only 8% from 52W highs, so limited upside cushion if the print is in-line vs. a beat.
ANALYSIS
Elite base_tight at 1.43 (textbook VCP), prox_52w 91.9%, positive RS vs SPY (+7.2) in a lagging Healthcare sector, and earnings 32 days out. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line is NOT at new highs, which would be required for an A grade under Qullamaggie methodology. Volume at 1.51x is also below the 2x threshold for institutional surge confirmation. This is a high-quality setup, but lacks the explosive momentum signature of an A-grade breakout. Conviction: Medium

Signal: Close above \$512.16 on vol >151% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.51x

